an active partner in negotiations regarding the future of the Occupied Territories. In place of the direct negotiations with the Palestine Authority that have been proven hopeless, the talks would be with a Jordanian-Palestinian confederation that would be responsible for the West Bank and Gaza. The degree of autonomy of the Palestinian entity within such a confederation would be determined in arrangements between Jordan and the Palestinians.

This sounds like a very reasonable step on the way to a solution of the Palestinian question, but to be feasible it needs both Jordan and the Palestinians to be on board. First and foremost it needs a different Israeli government (a precondition mentioned by the author) and some kind of acceptable solution of the settlements issue. All this is fraught with immense difficulties, but preferable to an endless stalemate with recurring eruptions of violence.

Netanyahu is manifestly playing for time. He rejects the humanitarian pause, does everything to appear the tough leader of his embattled country, calls Sinwar “a little Hitler in his bunker,” and in short is ready to sacrifice the interests of Israel by jeopardizing its close alliance with the United States, just to save his political skin.

Just how despicable Netanyahu is he proved again today. He apparently declared that Sinwar attacked us because pilots and other elite units refused to serve due to their opposition to the judicial overhaul. Gantz stated in response that launching such accusations in a time of war was weakening the country. Netanyahu denied the reports.

Strangely enough, lack of confidence in the country’s leadership did not exist to such an extent in 1973. I was in Jerusalem on that Yom Kippur day when the shock came, but then our Pugwash group at the Hebrew University organized to help the Ministry of Foreign Affairs in its effort to mobilize support for Israel overseas. On October 10 I was sent to France to get our narrative across. It was generally accepted, even on the left. And,